

Two-Computer Installation Guide

Live Auction Host + Cashier Workstation

Use this sequence exactly: install both PCs, collect both Machine IDs, activate both PCs, configure the host, then pair the cashier.

Installer	HammerTrackPro-0.7.0-x64.msi
Supported setup	Two Windows x64 computers on the same private local network
Computer 1	Live Auction Host - owns the auction database
Computer 2	Cashier Workstation - connects securely to the host

Important

Never place or share the HammerTrack database on a network drive. The host keeps the database locally; the cashier communicates with the host through HammerTrack's paired HTTPS connection.

Print this guide in color or grayscale at 100% scale on US Letter paper.

1. Before you begin

Gather everything before auction day. Perform the installation while both computers can remain on the same private network.

You will need

[ ] The HammerTrack Pro MSI installer on a USB drive or other trusted transfer method.

[ ] Administrator permission on both Windows computers.

[ ] One host computer for live-auction operation and one cashier computer.

[ ] Both computers connected to the same trusted private router or LAN.

[ ] A signed .htplicense file that includes the Machine ID of both computers.

Choose and label the computers

LIVE AUCTION HOST	Runs the auction, stores the local database, and must stay powered on while the cashier is working.
CASHIER	Looks up current-auction bidders and records payments through the secure connection to the host.

Do not use public Wi-Fi. If possible, connect both PCs by Ethernet to the same router for the most reliable auction-day connection.

Record for this installation

Auction company	_____
Host PC name	_____
Cashier PC name	_____
Installation date	_____

2. Install and activate both computers

1 **Install on the host**
Copy the MSI to the live-auction computer. Double-click it, approve the Windows administrator prompt, and complete the installer. Use the default installation folder.

2 **Install on the cashier**
Repeat the same MSI installation on the cashier computer.

3 **Launch HammerTrack Pro**
Use the new Desktop or Start Menu shortcut. If Windows shows a publisher warning for an unsigned build, confirm that the MSI came from your trusted HammerTrack provider before continuing.

4 **Collect both Machine IDs**
At the activation screen, select **Copy Machine ID** on each computer. Label each ID as Host or Cashier and send both IDs to the license issuer.

5 **Receive one license file**
The issuer creates one signed **.htplicense** file containing both Machine IDs. Keep the file private and unchanged.

6 **Activate both computers**
On each activation screen, import the same .htplicense file. HammerTrack confirms the licensed customer name.

A license for only one Machine ID will not activate the other PC. If either computer is replaced, request a replacement license containing the complete approved Machine ID list.

Activation record

Host Machine ID	_____
Cashier Machine ID	_____
License file received	_____ Date: _____

3. Configure the Live Auction Host

1. **Select the host role**
   On first setup, choose **Live Auction Host (stores the database)**, then save the selection. Restart HammerTrack if prompted or if you later change the role.

2. **Allow private-network access**
   If Windows Firewall asks, allow HammerTrack on **Private networks**. Do not enable it for public networks.

3. **Open Network Information**
   In HammerTrack, open **Network Information**. Leave this screen available while setting up the cashier.

4. **Copy the pairing values**
   Record the Host address, Alternate IP address, Pairing key, and Certificate fingerprint exactly as displayed. Keep the pairing key private.

5. **Keep the host running**
   HammerTrack must remain open on this computer whenever the cashier workstation is being used.

Host pairing record

Host address	_____
Alternate IP address	_____
Pairing key	_____ _____
Certificate fingerprint	_____ _____

The live-auction host is the only computer that opens the SQLite database. Never copy the live database to a shared, UNC, mapped-network, or cloud-synced folder.

4. Pair the Cashier Workstation

1. **Confirm the host is ready**
   The host PC must be running HammerTrack and both computers must be on the same private network.

2. **Select the cashier role**
   On the cashier setup screen, choose **Cashier Workstation (connects to host)**.

3. **Enter the secure connection values**
   Copy the **Host address**, **Pairing key**, and **Certificate fingerprint** from Network Information on the host. Include the full HTTPS address.

4. **Save and restart**
   Save the workstation setup. Restart HammerTrack after changing the workstation role or connection settings.

5. **Verify connection status**
   Open the cashier screen and confirm it connects to the host. The cashier retries health checks after a temporary disconnect.

If the computer-name Host address does not connect, edit cashier setup and use the Alternate IP address shown on the host. Keep the same pairing key and certificate fingerprint.

Run a pre-auction test

- [ ] On the host, select the correct Current Auction.
- [ ] On the cashier, confirm the connected state and current-auction context.
- [ ] Look up a test bidder registered for that auction.
- [ ] Confirm the expected purchases and totals appear only for the current auction.
- [ ] Do not record a real payment during the connection test unless it is intended and auditable.

Security note

The cashier pins the host certificate fingerprint and uses the pairing key. Do not bypass certificate or pairing errors; compare the values against the host's Network Information screen.

5. Troubleshooting and auction-day checklist

If the cashier will not connect

Disconnected	Confirm HammerTrack is open on the host and both PCs are connected to the same private router/LAN.
Host name fails	Use the Alternate IP address from the host's Network Information screen.
Not paired	Re-enter the pairing key exactly. Do not add spaces before or after it.
Fingerprint error	Re-enter the certificate fingerprint exactly as displayed on the host. Do not ignore a mismatch.
Still offline	Confirm Windows classified the network as Private and HammerTrack is allowed through the host firewall on Private networks.

If activation fails

PC not included	Send the displayed Machine ID to the license issuer and request a replacement license that retains all approved PCs.
Invalid file	Import the original .htplicense file without renaming its extension or editing its contents.
Expired license	Contact the license issuer for a renewed signed license.

Before bidders arrive

[ ] Host PC is connected to power and sleep is disabled for the event.

[ ] Cashier PC is connected and shows a healthy connection.

[ ] Correct Current Auction is selected on the host.

[ ] A recent in-app backup exists in the local Backups folder.

[ ] Network Information is available to the operator but the pairing key is not publicly visible.

[ ] A test bidder lookup succeeds from the cashier.

Data location: %ProgramData%\HammerTrackPro. Application upgrades and uninstall are designed to preserve the database, backups, logs, settings, and license, but maintain current backups before any upgrade or service work.

Installation completed by: _____ Date: _____